



How can India build a credible examination system that ensures fairness, autonomy, and meaningful assessment?

Radhakrishnan Committee • National Testing Agency • Computer-Adaptive Testing • Psychometrics • Academic Autonomy

GS II
Governance
Education and
Human Resource
Development

KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Institutional Reform:** The 2024 Radhakrishnan Committee proposed restructuring the National Testing Agency into a statutory, professionally managed institution. Strong governance, specialised functional divisions, and legal backing improve examination credibility, accountability, and operational independence.
- **Assessment Philosophy:** Entrance examinations should evaluate analytical ability, conceptual understanding, and application rather than rote memorisation. Sound Psychometrics enables scientifically designed assessments that improve reliability, fairness, and measurement of genuine academic competence.
- **Technology Integration:** Computer-Adaptive Testing adjusts question difficulty according to candidate performance, improving precision while reducing opportunities for malpractice. Secure digital infrastructure, biometric verification, cybersecurity, and standardised testing centres strengthen examination integrity.
- **Academic Ownership:** High-quality examinations require continuous involvement of universities, professional institutions, and subject experts. Academic Autonomy ensures question quality, curriculum relevance, institutional responsibility, and greater public confidence in national assessment systems.
- **Implementation Challenges:** Institutional reforms require adequate staffing, specialised expertise, statutory support, sustainable funding, and administrative capacity. Long-term success depends on coordinated governance rather than isolated technological solutions or temporary crisis management.

QUICK FACTS

- **Radhakrishnan Committee (2024):** Recommended transforming the National Testing Agency into a statutory institution with specialised functional verticals for examination governance.
- **National Testing Agency:** Established in 2018 as an autonomous organisation under the Ministry of Education to conduct major national entrance examinations.
- **Computer-Adaptive Testing:** Widely used in international examinations such as the GRE, where question difficulty changes according to candidate responses.
- **Psychometrics:** The scientific discipline concerned with designing, validating, and evaluating tests to ensure reliability, validity, and fairness of assessments.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Credible public examinations require strong institutions, scientific assessment methods, academic participation, and transparent governance rather than relying solely on technological safeguards.

MAINS PERSPECTIVE

How can India build a credible examination system that ensures fairness, autonomy, and meaningful assessment?

A credible national examination system is essential for ensuring merit-based access to higher education while maintaining public trust. Beyond preventing malpractice, examinations must accurately measure knowledge, analytical ability, and academic potential through transparent and professionally managed institutions.

Institutional reforms should strengthen the National Testing Agency with statutory status, specialised functional divisions, and adequate professional capacity as recommended by the Radhakrishnan Committee. Scientific assessment practices such as Psychometrics and Computer-Adaptive Testing can improve reliability and fairness while secure digital infrastructure, biometric verification, and cybersecurity protect examination integrity. Equally important is Academic Autonomy through active participation of universities, professional bodies, and subject experts in question design, evaluation standards, and curriculum alignment. Sustainable recruitment, legal backing, and administrative coordination are necessary for effective implementation.

India's examination reforms should balance technological innovation with institutional independence and academic expertise. A transparent, professionally governed assessment system will enhance fairness, improve educational quality, and strengthen confidence in national entrance examinations.

DAILY MCQs

- **Psychometrics is primarily concerned with:**
 - A. Digital encryption of examination data
 - B. Scientific measurement and evaluation of human abilities through tests
 - C. Recruitment of examination officials
 - D. Financial management of educational institutions
- **Which one of the following is the principal advantage of Computer-Adaptive Testing?**
 - A. Every candidate receives identical question papers.
 - B. Question difficulty changes according to candidate performance.
 - C. It eliminates the need for examination centres.
 - D. It guarantees identical scores across multiple attempts.
- **Consider the following statements regarding a credible national examination system: Academic participation improves question quality and assessment standards. Technological safeguards alone are sufficient to guarantee examination integrity. Statutory institutional autonomy can strengthen public confidence. Which of the statements given above are correct?**
 - A. 1 only
 - B. 1 and 3 only
 - C. 2 and 3 only
 - D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer Key • 1-B • 2-B • 3-B



How can constitutional democracies protect peaceful protest while ensuring proportionate policing and public order?

Article 19 • Proportionality • Graduated Response • Independent Inquiry • Seventh Schedule

GS II
Polity
Fundamental Rights

KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Constitutional Protection:** Peaceful protest is a democratic means of expressing dissent and influencing public policy. Article 19 protects freedom of speech and peaceful assembly while permitting only reasonable restrictions to safeguard legitimate public interests.
- **Proportionate Policing:** Law enforcement must use only the minimum force necessary to address actual threats. The principle of Proportionality requires police action to remain lawful, necessary, reasonable, and appropriate to the circumstances.
- **Graduated Response:** Modern crowd management follows a Graduated Response by prioritising communication, warnings, protective equipment, negotiation, and controlled escalation before resorting to stronger crowd-control measures to minimise injuries and preserve public confidence.
- **Independent Oversight:** Allegations of excessive force require impartial investigation to maintain institutional credibility. Independent Inquiry, evidence preservation, medical documentation, and transparent accountability mechanisms strengthen both public trust and professional policing standards.
- **Uniform Standards:** Policing is a State subject under the Seventh Schedule, leading to variations in training and operational practices. National protocols can promote consistent documentation, accountability, and human-rights-compliant crowd-control procedures across States.

QUICK FACTS

- Article 19(1)(a) and Article 19(1)(b): Guarantee freedom of speech and the right to assemble peacefully without arms, reasonable restrictions under Articles 19(2) and 19(3).
- Seventh Schedule: Places "Police" and "Public Order" in the State List, making States primarily responsible for policing and law-and-order administration.
- UN Basic Principles on the Use of Force and Firearms: Require law-enforcement officials to use force only when necessary, lawful, and proportionate to a legitimate objective.
- Prakash Singh v. Union of India (2006): The Supreme Court directed structural police reforms, including State Security Commissions and Police Complaints Authorities to improve accountability.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Constitutional democracy protects peaceful dissent most effectively when policing remains lawful, proportionate, transparent, and accountable while preserving both public order and civil liberties.

MAINS PERSPECTIVE

How can constitutional democracies protect peaceful protest while ensuring proportionate policing and public order?

Peaceful protest is an essential feature of constitutional democracy because it enables citizens to express dissent and influence public decision-making. At the same time, the State has a legitimate responsibility to maintain public order, protect life, and safeguard the rights of other citizens.

Article 19 guarantees freedom of speech and peaceful assembly while permitting reasonable restrictions in the interests of public order. Therefore, police action should always satisfy the principle of Proportionality by using only the minimum force necessary. A Graduated Response involving dialogue, warnings, adequate protective equipment, and controlled escalation should precede coercive measures wherever possible. Since policing falls under the Seventh Schedule, operational standards vary across States. National protocols, proper documentation, medical assistance after use of force, evidence preservation, and Independent Inquiry into serious incidents can improve accountability and public confidence. The Prakash Singh judgment further emphasises institutional reforms that strengthen police professionalism and oversight.

A democratic society must neither criminalise peaceful dissent nor tolerate violence. Protecting civil liberties through accountable, proportionate, and transparent policing strengthens the rule of law and reinforces public trust in constitutional institutions.

DAILY MCQs

- Which of the following rights directly protects peaceful public demonstrations under the Constitution of India?
 - A. Article 21
 - B. Article 19(1)(b)
 - C. Article 32
 - D. Article 226
- The principle of "Proportionality" in policing implies that:
 - A. Police may use maximum force whenever public inconvenience occurs.
 - B. Police action should be necessary and limited to the minimum force required.
 - C. Every protest requires prior judicial approval.
 - D. Public order always overrides fundamental rights.
- Consider the following statements: Police and Public Order are subjects under the State List of the Seventh Schedule. Independent investigation into allegations of excessive police force enhances institutional credibility. Peaceful assembly under Article 19 is an absolute right without any restrictions. Which of the statements given above are correct?
 - A. 1 and 2 only
 - B. 2 and 3 only
 - C. 1 and 3 only
 - D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer Key • 1-B • 2-B • 3-A



How can India balance farmer income security with efficient and sustainable agricultural market reforms?

Minimum Support Price • Price Deficiency Payment • Minimum Income Support • Pulse Self-Sufficiency • Crop Diversification

GS III
Agriculture
Agricultural
Marketing

KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Price Support:** Minimum Support Price (MSP) protects farmers from sharp price declines by assuring a minimum procurement price. However, procurement is often selective, fiscally expensive, and unable to cover the entire marketed surplus across crops and regions.
- **Price Deficiency Payment:** Under a Price Deficiency Payment system, governments compensate farmers for the gap between the MSP and the market price without physically procuring produce. This reduces storage costs while providing income protection.
- **Minimum Income Support:** Minimum Income Support (MIP) provides direct per-acre financial assistance independent of procurement. Stable income support allows farmers to make production decisions based on market demand rather than government procurement incentives.
- **Crop Diversification:** Expanding cultivation of pulses and oilseeds strengthens Pulse Self-Sufficiency, reduces import dependence, conserves water compared to surplus cereals, and promotes more balanced and climate-resilient agricultural systems.
- **Market-Oriented Reforms:** Long-term agricultural sustainability requires Crop Diversification, rural infrastructure, agricultural research, crop insurance, and efficient markets. Productive public investment can improve farm incomes more effectively than excessive reliance on price support alone.

QUICK FACTS

- **Minimum Support Price:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) recommends MSPs for 23 notified crops, while the Union Government announces the final MSPs.
- **PM-AASHA Scheme (2018):** Introduced mechanisms including Price Deficiency Payment to support farmers when market prices fall below MSP for selected crops.
- **PM-KISAN:** Provides income support of ₹6,000 annually to eligible farmer families through Direct Benefit Transfer, independent of crop procurement.
- **India remains substantially dependent on imports of edible oils, making higher domestic production of oilseeds an important agricultural policy objective.**

KEY TAKEAWAY

Sustainable agricultural prosperity depends on securing farmer incomes through efficient markets, diversified cropping, and targeted income support rather than relying primarily on large-scale procurement.

MAINS PERSPECTIVE

How can India balance farmer income security with efficient and sustainable agricultural market reforms?

Farmer welfare requires stable incomes while ensuring agricultural markets remain efficient, fiscally sustainable, and responsive to changing demand. Although Minimum Support Price has protected farmers against price volatility, procurement-based support has important financial and operational limitations.

A balanced approach should combine Minimum Support Price with market-oriented reforms. Price Deficiency Payment allows governments to compensate farmers without creating excessive procurement and storage burdens. Minimum Income Support through direct transfers provides predictable income while enabling farmers to choose crops according to market demand. Greater emphasis on Crop Diversification towards pulses and oilseeds can reduce import dependence, improve soil health, conserve water, and strengthen food security. Investments in agricultural research, irrigation, rural infrastructure, crop insurance, and digital market access further improve farm productivity and resilience. Such reforms reduce market distortions while strengthening long-term agricultural competitiveness.

Agricultural policy should move beyond price protection towards comprehensive income security and productivity enhancement. A balanced combination of market reforms, public investment, and targeted support can improve farmer welfare while ensuring sustainable agricultural growth.

DAILY MCQs

- **The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) primarily performs which one of the following functions?**
 - Procures agricultural produce on behalf of States.
 - Recommends Minimum Support Prices for notified crops.
 - Provides direct income support to farmers.
 - Regulates agricultural commodity exchanges.
- **Which of the following best describes a Price Deficiency Payment system?**
 - Government purchases the entire crop from farmers.
 - Farmers receive compensation for the difference between MSP and market price.
 - Farmers receive free agricultural inputs instead of cash.
 - Crop insurance claims are automatically settled after harvest.
- **Consider the following statements: Crop Diversification towards pulses and oilseeds can reduce India's import dependence. Minimum Income Support provides financial assistance independent of physical procurement. Minimum Support Price guarantees government procurement of every crop produced by every farmer. Which of the statements given above are correct?**
 - 1 and 2 only
 - 2 and 3 only
 - 1 and 3 only
 - 1, 2 and 3

Answer Key • 1-B • 2-B • 3-A



How can durable peace in Gaza balance security concerns, humanitarian needs, and political reconciliation?

Two-State Solution • Demilitarisation • Humanitarian Law • Collective Punishment • Post-Conflict Reconstruction

GS II
International Relations
West Asia

KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Conflict Resolution:** Long-term peace requires addressing both immediate security concerns and the underlying political dispute. The internationally supported Two-State Solution remains the most widely accepted framework for achieving lasting peace between Israel and Palestine.
- **Demilitarisation:** Demilitarisation seeks to reduce or eliminate armed capabilities to prevent renewed conflict. Successful implementation depends on credible security guarantees, mutual trust, phased commitments, and effective international monitoring by neutral institutions.
- **Humanitarian Protection:** International Humanitarian Law requires parties to armed conflict to protect civilians and ensure access to food, medicine, and essential services. Humanitarian assistance must remain independent of political or military negotiations during armed conflicts.
- **Collective Punishment:** Collective Punishment occurs when civilian populations are penalised for actions they did not individually commit. International humanitarian law prohibits measures that intentionally inflict suffering on civilians to achieve military or political objectives.
- **Peacebuilding:** Post-Conflict Reconstruction extends beyond rebuilding infrastructure to restoring governance, public services, livelihoods, and institutional legitimacy. Sustainable peace depends on inclusive political arrangements, economic recovery, and long-term reconciliation among affected communities.

QUICK FACTS

- **Fourth Geneva Convention (1949):** Provides legal protection to civilians during armed conflict and prohibits collective punishment in occupied territories.
- **United Nations Relief and Works Agency (UNRWA):** Supports Palestinian refugees by providing education, healthcare, and humanitarian assistance across the region.
- **Two-State Solution:** Envisions Israel and an independent Palestinian state coexisting peacefully based on negotiated political arrangements.
- **Oslo Accords (1993–95):** Established mutual recognition between Israel and the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) and created the Palestinian Authority as an interim self-governing body.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Lasting peace in conflict zones requires balancing legitimate security concerns with humanitarian obligations, inclusive political dialogue, and sustainable post-conflict reconstruction.

MAINS PERSPECTIVE

How can durable peace in Gaza balance security concerns, humanitarian needs, and political reconciliation?

Achieving durable peace in Gaza requires addressing both immediate security challenges and the deeper political causes of the conflict. Sustainable peace cannot rely solely on military arrangements but must also protect civilians, restore governance, and create conditions for long-term political stability.

Demilitarisation can reduce the risk of renewed violence when implemented through phased agreements, credible security guarantees, and international monitoring. At the same time, International Humanitarian Law requires uninterrupted humanitarian access, protection of civilians, and prohibits Collective Punishment irrespective of ongoing negotiations. Post-Conflict Reconstruction should restore housing, healthcare, education, and essential infrastructure while rebuilding institutions capable of delivering public services. Political reconciliation through negotiations based on the Two-State Solution remains central to addressing competing national aspirations and reducing the likelihood of recurring conflict. International organisations and regional stakeholders also have an important role in facilitating dialogue, humanitarian assistance, and reconstruction efforts.

Enduring peace demands that security, humanitarian protection, and political settlement advance together rather than sequentially. A balanced, rules-based approach offers the strongest foundation for stability and regional cooperation.

DAILY MCQs

- **Which of the following international legal instruments specifically provides protection to civilians during armed conflict and prohibits collective punishment?**
 - United Nations Charter
 - Fourth Geneva Convention
 - Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations
 - Rome Statute of the International Criminal Court
- **The concept of "Demilitarisation" primarily refers to:**
 - Expansion of military alliances.
 - Reduction or elimination of armed military capabilities in a specified area.
 - Replacement of civilian governments by military administration.
 - Complete withdrawal from international treaties.
- **Consider the following statements: International Humanitarian Law requires protection of civilians during armed conflict. The Two-State Solution seeks the peaceful coexistence of Israel and an independent Palestinian state. Collective Punishment is recognised as a lawful method of enforcing compliance during armed conflict. Which of the statements given above are correct?**
 - 1 and 2 only
 - 2 and 3 only
 - 1 and 3 only
 - 1, 2 and 3

Answer Key • 1-B • 2-B • 3-A